

Benefits Guide

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1. Overview

This guide summarizes Solarium's benefits program for U.S.-based regular employees working 20+ hours/week. It is a summary for everyday reference — the governing documents are the official plan documents (Summary Plan Descriptions) held by People Operations and each carrier, which control in the event of any conflict with this guide.

2. Eligibility and Enrollment Windows

- Benefits eligibility begins on your **first day of employment** for employees regularly scheduled 20+ hours/week.
- You have **30 days from your hire date** to make elections; see SOL-HR-104 (Onboarding Guide) for the enrollment process.
- **Open enrollment** occurs once a year, typically in November, for coverage effective the following January 1.
- **Qualifying life events** (marriage, divorce, birth/adoption, loss of other coverage, and similar) open a 30-day special enrollment window outside the annual cycle — report the event to People Operations promptly, since some elections (like adding a new dependent) have their own sub-deadlines.

3. Health, Dental, and Vision Insurance

Plan	Employee Monthly Cost (self-only)	Solarium Contribution	Key Features
PPO Health Plan	\$85	85% of total premium	Lower deductible (\$750 individual), larger provider network, no PCP referral required
High-Deductible Health Plan (HDHP) + HSA	\$35	90% of total premium	Higher deductible (\$2,000 individual), pairs with an HSA — Solarium contributes \$500/year (individual) or \$1,000/year (family) to your HSA
Dental (PPO)	\$12	80% of total premium	Preventive care covered at 100%; orthodontia coverage for dependents under 19
Vision	\$6	80% of total premium	Annual eye exam, allowance toward frames/lenses or contacts

- Dependent coverage (spouse/partner, children) is available on all plans; employee cost scales with the number of covered dependents — see exact tiered pricing in the enrollment portal, since it varies by plan and dependent count.
- Domestic partners are eligible for coverage on the same basis as spouses; some domestic partner benefits may be treated as taxable income under federal law (this is a tax rule, not a Solarium policy choice) — Payroll can explain the tax treatment for your situation.
- Both plans include an Employee Assistance Program (EAP) at no cost, covering confidential short-term counseling (up to 6 sessions per issue per year), legal/financial consultation referrals, and crisis support, available even if you don't enroll in a Solarium health plan at all.

4. Retirement Plan (401(k))

- Eligible from your first day of employment; auto-enrolled at a **4% contribution rate** 30 days after hire unless you actively opt out or change your rate during that window.
- **Company match:** 100% of the first 4% you contribute, then 50% of the next 2% (effectively up to 5% company match on a 6% employee contribution) — this is a dollar-for-dollar match on the first 4%, which is worth capturing at minimum if you can.
- Match contributions vest immediately — there is no vesting schedule or waiting period for the match itself.
- You can change your contribution rate or investment elections at any time, not just during open enrollment, through the retirement plan portal.
- Roth and traditional (pre-tax) 401(k) contributions are both available; the company match is always contributed on a pre-tax basis regardless of which option you choose for your own contributions.

5. Life and Disability Insurance

- **Basic life insurance:** 1x annual base salary, provided automatically at no cost to you, up to a plan maximum.
- **Supplemental life insurance:** available for purchase at group rates, up to 5x salary for yourself and defined amounts for a spouse/partner and children, with guaranteed issue (no medical exam) up to a threshold during your initial enrollment window only.
- **Short-term disability:** covers a portion of income (60%) for a qualifying non-work illness or injury lasting more than 7 days, up to 12 weeks, provided at no cost to you.
- **Long-term disability:** covers 60% of income after a 90-day waiting period (coordinated with short-term disability so there's no gap), provided at no cost to you, for qualifying long-term conditions.

6. Wellness Benefits

- **Wellness stipend:** \$75/month, usable for gym memberships, fitness classes, mental health apps, or similar wellness expenses — submitted like a normal expense (see SOL-FIN-301) under the "Wellness" category, no manager pre-approval required within the monthly cap.
- **Mental health support:** in addition to EAP counseling sessions (Section 3), both health plans cover ongoing therapy and psychiatry at standard in-network cost-sharing rates.

- **Annual wellness day:** 1 additional paid day per year, separate from PTO, intended for a preventive health appointment, mental health day, or similar — no justification required, request it like a PTO day.

7. Flexible Spending Accounts (FSA)

- **Healthcare FSA:** pre-tax contributions up to the annual IRS limit for eligible medical, dental, and vision expenses not covered by insurance. Available on the PPO plan (not compatible with the HDHP/HSA plan by IRS rule).
- **Dependent Care FSA:** pre-tax contributions up to the annual IRS limit for eligible child or dependent adult care expenses, available regardless of which health plan you choose.
- FSA elections are generally "use it or lose it" for the plan year, though Solarium's plan includes a \$640 (or current IRS-adjusted limit) carryover allowance for the Healthcare FSA — check the plan document for the current year's exact carryover figure.

8. Other Benefits

- **Paid parental leave, bereavement, jury duty:** see SOL-HR-101.
- **Home office stipend:** see SOL-OPS-201.
- **Professional development budget:** \$1,000/year, described in SOL-FIN-301 Section 3.
- **Employee referral bonus:** \$2,500 for a successful hire referred through the internal referral program, paid after the new hire completes 90 days, described fully on the internal Talent Acquisition page.
- **Commuter benefits** (for office-based/hybrid employees near a participating office): pre-tax payroll deduction for transit and parking, up to the current IRS pre-tax limit.

9. Non-U.S. Employees

Employees outside the United States receive a locally appropriate benefits package designed to be equivalent in overall value, coordinated by your local People Operations partner, since specific benefit types (e.g., statutory pension schemes, national health systems) vary significantly by country. Ask your local HR partner for your country-specific benefits summary — this U.S.-focused guide does not directly apply to non-U.S. plan details, though the general benefits *philosophy* (competitive, comprehensive, day-one eligible where legally possible) is consistent globally.

10. Changing or Canceling Elections

Outside of open enrollment or a qualifying life event, benefit elections generally cannot be changed mid-year, consistent with IRS Section 125 cafeteria plan rules that govern most employer-sponsored benefits — this is a federal tax rule that applies to employers generally, not a Solarium-specific restriction. If you're unsure whether your situation qualifies as a life event, ask People Operations rather than assuming either way.

Frequently Referenced Numbers

- Benefits eligibility: Day 1 of employment (20+ hours/week)

- Enrollment window: 30 days from hire
- 401(k) auto-enrollment: 4%, with match up to 5% on a 6% contribution
- Wellness stipend: \$75/month
- Annual wellness day: 1 paid day, separate from PTO
- Professional development: \$1,000/year
- Employee referral bonus: \$2,500 after 90 days

Related documents: SOL-HR-101 (PTO and Leave Policy), SOL-HR-104 (New Hire Onboarding Guide), SOL-FIN-301 (Expense Reimbursement Policy).